

TidyTuesday Week 35

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Wednesday 26th August, 2026

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1 Weekly Summary

AI-Generated Content

The summary below was written by Claude (Anthropic) from that week's regression outputs and series descriptions. It has not been reviewed or fact-checked by a human, and should be read as an automated, informal recap – not analysis.

Welcome back to the only newsletter where a computer flings two unrelated economic time series into a blender every morning and we all pretend to be surprised by what comes out. This week the machine really outdid itself, serving up a lineup of pairings so arbitrary that even the spreadsheet seemed embarrassed. As always, the standing disclaimer: nothing here is a real finding, no series is causing any other series, and if you take investment advice from this document that is between you and your therapist.

Monday, August 24, we matched Other Business Receivables Owned by Finance Companies against a nonfarm employment diffusion index, because why not. The raw regression produced an R-squared of roughly 0.007, which is a fancy way of saying the line explains basically nothing, and a p-value of about 0.10 that couldn't quite muster the enthusiasm to call itself significant. Then we detrended it, and – hold onto your hats – absolutely nothing changed. Same nothing, now trend-free. A rare case where the raw and detrended versions agree completely, and what they agree on is that these two series have never met and would not recognize each other at a party.

Tuesday, August 25, was the highlight of the week for connoisseurs of technical failure. We paired Auto Production Seasonal Factors (monthly) with Reissue Patents Originating in Romania (annual, and last seen in 2020), and the regression returned a glorious wall of zeros and NaNs. That's the statistics equivalent of the machine staring at us in silence. Turns out asking a monthly seasonal fudge-factor to explain the number of Romanian reissue patents produces exactly the intellectual content you'd expect: none, formatted as errors. Chef's kiss. Truly the correlation we deserved.

Then Wednesday, August 26, the week suddenly grew a spine. We ran the San Francisco Tech Pulse against the labor force of women with master's degrees, and the raw regression came in significant with an R-squared near 0.10. Fine, you say, both drift upward over time, classic trend mirage, dunk incoming. Except this one refused to collapse – detrended, it got stronger, R-squared climbing to about 0.14 with a p-value in the "three zeros then a three" range. So after we stripped out the shared upward drift, a relationship was still standing there, waving. One could spin a tale about a booming tech economy pulling more highly educated women into the workforce, and it would even sound plausible, which is precisely why I'm legally obligated to remind you it's still two randomly grabbed series and proves nothing. But credit where due: in a week that also produced a page of NaNs, this was a genuinely respectable little result. See you next week for more statistical noise dressed up as insight.

2 Date: 2026-08-24

Series ID: DTBOOXDFBANM

This series is titled Other Business Receivables Owned by Finance Companies, Flow and has a frequency of Monthly. The units are Millions of Dollars, Monthly Rate and the seasonal adjustment is Not Seasonally Adjusted. The observation start date is 1980-07-01 and the observation end date is 2026-05-01. The popularity of this series is 1.

Series ID: SMS000000000000000022

This series is titled Diffusion Indexes, 3-Month Span: Total Nonfarm and has a frequency of Monthly. The units are Index and the seasonal adjustment is Seasonally Adjusted. The observation start date is 1991-01-01 and the observation end date is 2026-07-01. The popularity of this series is 17.

2.1 Raw Regression

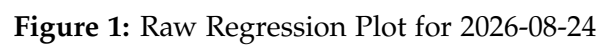
Regresses the two series against each other directly. A significant result here can come just as easily from both series sharing a long-run trend as from any real relationship.

Dep. Variable:	value_fred_SMS000000000000000022	R-squared:	0.007			
Model:	OLS	Adj. R-squared:	0.004			
Method:	Least Squares	F-statistic:	2.780			
Date:	Mon, 24 Aug 2026	Prob (F-statistic):	0.0962			
Time:	12:21:23	Log-Likelihood:	-1980.1			
No. Observations:	425	AIC:	3964.			
Df Residuals:	423	BIC:	3972.			
Df Model:	1					
Covariance Type:	nonrobust					
	coef	std err	t	P> t	[0.025	0.975]
const	76.2916	1.244	61.331	0.000	73.847	78.737
value_fred_DTBOOXDFBANM	0.0009	0.001	1.667	0.096	-0.000	0.002
Omnibus:	115.402	Durbin-Watson:	0.217			
Prob(Omnibus):	0.000	Jarque-Bera (JB):	214.702			
Skew:	-1.569	Prob(JB):	2.39e-47			
Kurtosis:	4.511	Cond. No.	2.40e+03			

Notes:

[1] Standard Errors assume that the covariance matrix of the errors is correctly specified.

[2] The condition number is large, 2.4e+03. This might indicate that there are strong multicollinearity or other numerical problems.



2.2 Detrended Regression

Regresses the residuals of each series after removing its own linear time trend, so a shared trend can no longer drive the result on its own. A relationship that stays significant here is better evidence of a genuine link between the two series.

Dep. Variable:	value_fred_SMS00000000000000022_detrended	R-squared:	0.006
Model:	OLS	Adj. R-squared:	0.004
Method:	Least Squares	F-statistic:	2.758
Date:	Mon, 24 Aug 2026	Prob (F-statistic):	0.0975
Time:	12:21:24	Log-Likelihood:	-1980.1
No. Observations:	425	AIC:	3964.
Df Residuals:	423	BIC:	3972.
Df Model:	1		
Covariance Type:	nonrobust		

	coef	std err	t	P> t	[0.025	0.975]
const	4.49e-14	1.242	3.62e-14	1.000	-2.441	2.441
value_fred_DTBOOXDFBANM_detrended	0.0009	0.001	1.661	0.098	-0.000	0.002

Omnibus:	115.439	Durbin-Watson:	0.217
Prob(Omnibus):	0.000	Jarque-Bera (JB):	214.833
Skew:	-1.569	Prob(JB):	2.24e-47
Kurtosis:	4.513	Cond. No.	2.39e+03

Notes:

[1] Standard Errors assume that the covariance matrix of the errors is correctly specified.

[2] The condition number is large, 2.39e+03. This might indicate that there are strong multicollinearity or other numerical problems.

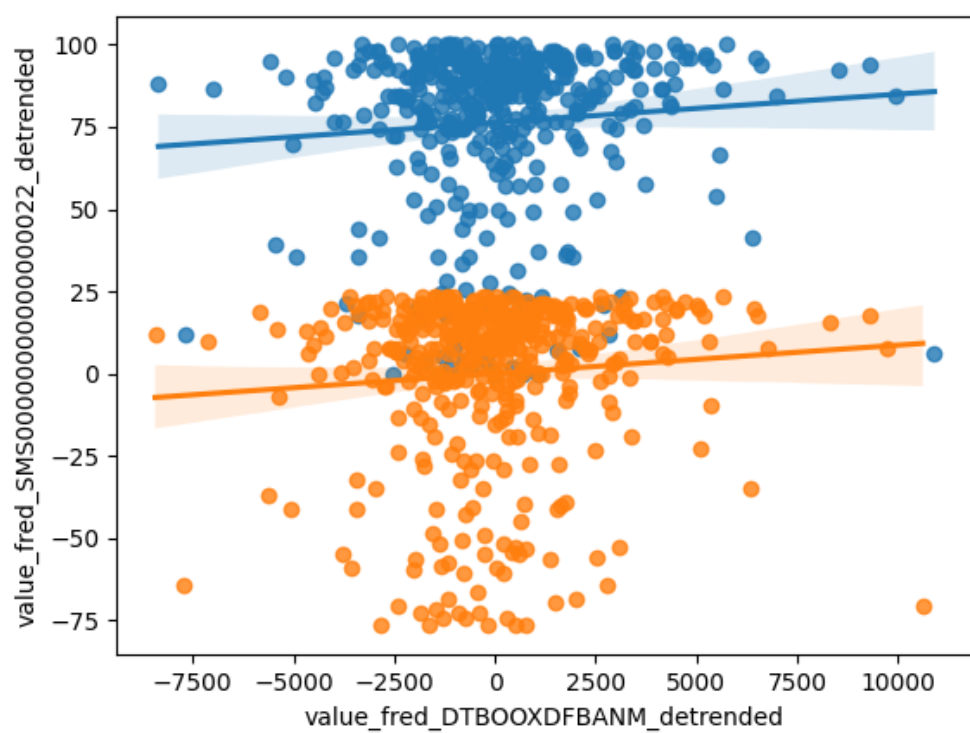


Figure 2: Detrended Regression Plot for 2026-08-24

3 Date: 2026-08-25

Series ID: G17MVSFAUTOS

This series is titled Regular Seasonal Factors: Auto Production and has a frequency of Monthly. The units are Seasonal Factor and the seasonal adjustment is Not Seasonally Adjusted. The observation start date is 1996-01-01 and the observation end date is 2027-09-01. The popularity of this series is 4.

Series ID: PATENT4NROREISSUE

This series is titled U.S. Granted Patents: Reissue Patents Originating in Romania and has a frequency of Annual. The units are Number and the seasonal adjustment is Not Seasonally Adjusted. The observation start date is 1993-01-01 and the observation end date is 2020-01-01. The popularity of this series is 1.

3.1 Raw Regression

Regresses the two series against each other directly. A significant result here can come just as easily from both series sharing a long-run trend as from any real relationship.

Dep. Variable:	value_fred_PATENT4NROREISSUE	R-squared:	nan
Model:	OLS	Adj. R-squared:	nan
Method:	Least Squares	F-statistic:	nan
Date:	Tue, 25 Aug 2026	Prob (F-statistic):	nan
Time:	12:22:02	Log-Likelihood:	inf
No. Observations:	25	AIC:	-inf
Df Residuals:	23	BIC:	-inf
Df Model:	1		
Covariance Type:	nonrobust		

	coef	std err	t	P> t	[0.025	0.975]
const	0	0	nan	nan	0	0
value_fred_G17MVSFAUTOS	0	0	nan	nan	0	0

Omnibus:	nan	Durbin-Watson:	nan
Prob(Omnibus):	nan	Jarque-Bera (JB):	nan
Skew:	nan	Prob(JB):	nan
Kurtosis:	nan	Cond. No.	2.33e+03

Notes:

[1] Standard Errors assume that the covariance matrix of the errors is correctly specified.

[2] The condition number is large, 2.33e+03. This might indicate that there are strong multicollinearity or other numerical problems.

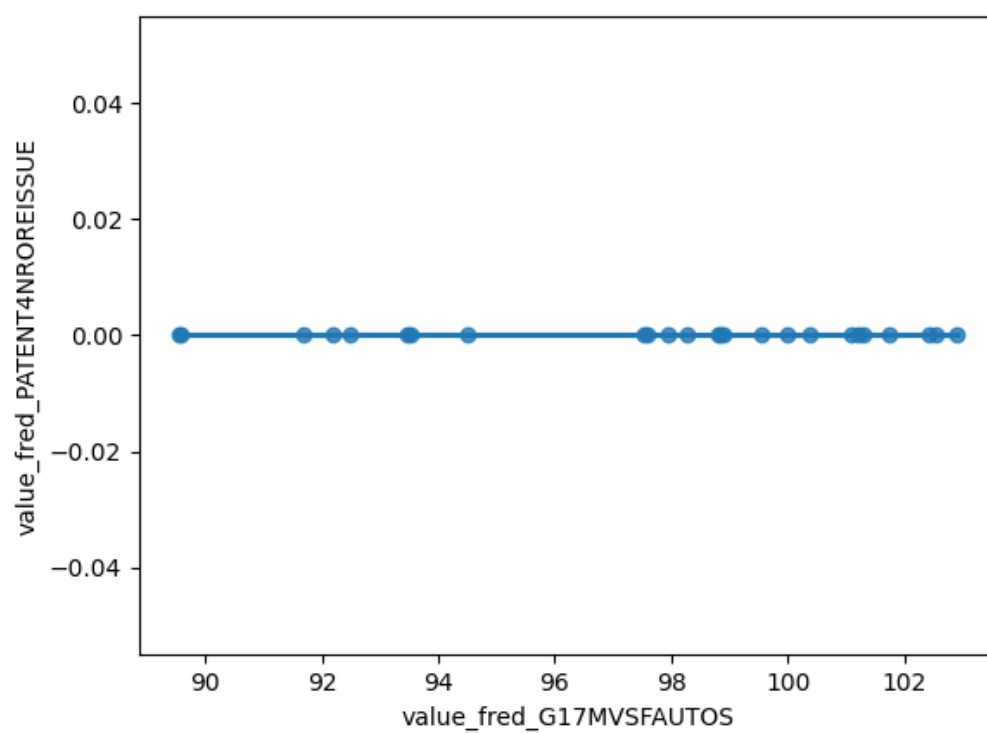


Figure 3: Raw Regression Plot for 2026-08-25

3.2 Detrended Regression

Regresses the residuals of each series after removing its own linear time trend, so a shared trend can no longer drive the result on its own. A relationship that stays significant here is better evidence of a genuine link between the two series.

Dep. Variable:	value_fred_PATENT4NRROREISSUE_detrended	R-squared:	nan
Model:	OLS	Adj. R-squared:	nan
Method:	Least Squares	F-statistic:	nan
Date:	Tue, 25 Aug 2026	Prob (F-statistic):	nan
Time:	12:22:03	Log-Likelihood:	inf
No. Observations:	25	AIC:	-inf
Df Residuals:	23	BIC:	-inf
Df Model:	1		
Covariance Type:	nonrobust		

	coef	std err	t	P> t	[0.025	0.975]
const	0	0	nan	nan	0	0
value_fred_G17MVSFAUTOS_detrended	0	0	nan	nan	0	0

Omnibus:	nan	Durbin-Watson:	nan
Prob(Omnibus):	nan	Jarque-Bera (JB):	nan
Skew:	nan	Prob(JB):	nan
Kurtosis:	nan	Cond. No.	3.92

Notes:

[1] Standard Errors assume that the covariance matrix of the errors is correctly specified.

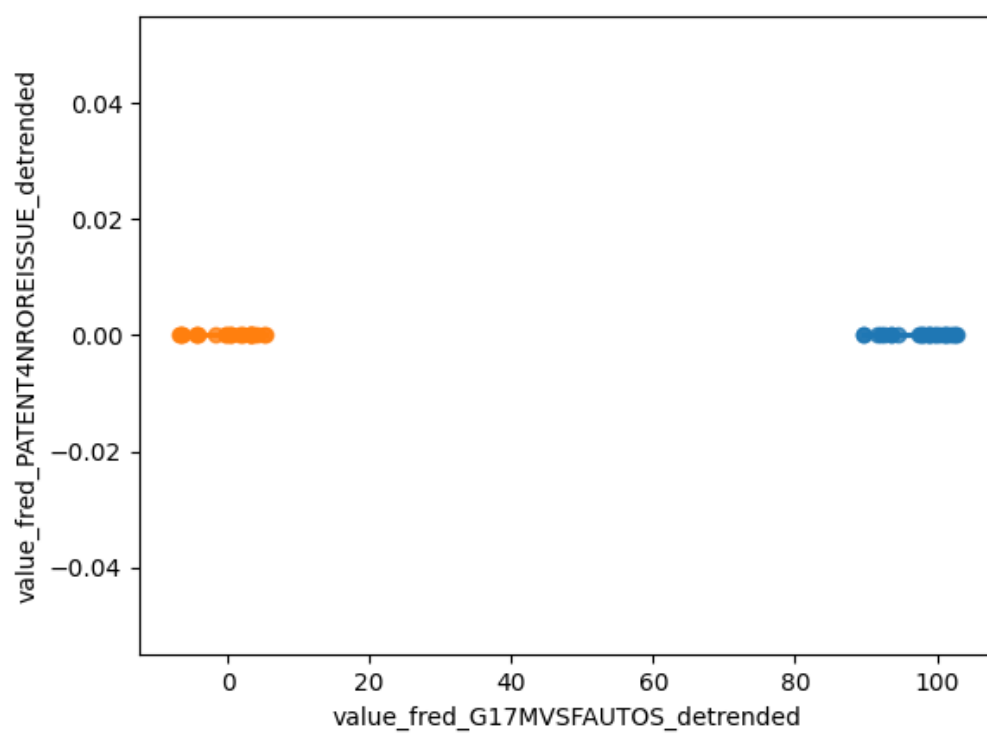


Figure 4: Detrended Regression Plot for 2026-08-25

4 Date: 2026-08-26

Series ID: SFTPINDM114SFRBSF

This series is titled San Francisco Tech Pulse (DISCONTINUED) and has a frequency of Monthly. The units are Index Jan 2000=100 and the seasonal adjustment is Seasonally Adjusted. The observation start date is 1971-04-01 and the observation end date is 2020-03-01. The popularity of this series is 9.

Series ID: CGMDLW2564

This series is titled Civilian Labor Force - College Graduates - Master's Degree, 25 to 64 years, Women and has a frequency of Monthly. The units are Thousands of Persons and the seasonal adjustment is Not Seasonally Adjusted. The observation start date is 2000-01-01 and the observation end date is 2026-07-01. The popularity of this series is 1.

4.1 Raw Regression

Regresses the two series against each other directly. A significant result here can come just as easily from both series sharing a long-run trend as from any real relationship.

Dep. Variable:	value_fred_CGMDLW2564	R-squared:	0.100
Model:	OLS	Adj. R-squared:	0.096
Method:	Least Squares	F-statistic:	26.65
Date:	Wed, 26 Aug 2026	Prob (F-statistic):	5.10e-07
Time:	12:24:10	Log-Likelihood:	-2072.8
No. Observations:	243	AIC:	4150.
Df Residuals:	241	BIC:	4157.
Df Model:	1		
Covariance Type:	nonrobust		

	coef	std err	t	P> t	[0.025	0.975]
const	3082.1539	563.746	5.467	0.000	1971.655	4192.653
value_fred_SFTPINDM114SFRBSF	34.1431	6.614	5.162	0.000	21.115	47.172

Omnibus:	8.541	Durbin-Watson:	0.010
Prob(Omnibus):	0.014	Jarque-Bera (JB):	8.940
Skew:	-0.458	Prob(JB):	0.0114
Kurtosis:	2.789	Cond. No.	609.

Notes:

[1] Standard Errors assume that the covariance matrix of the errors is correctly specified.

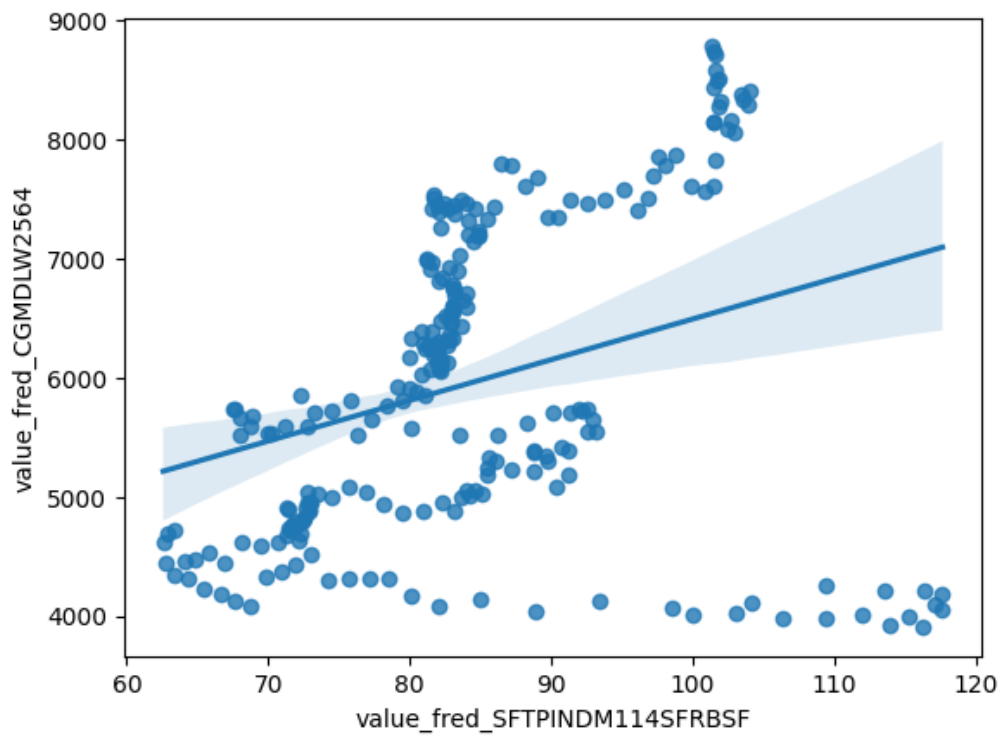


Figure 5: Raw Regression Plot for 2026-08-26

4.2 Detrended Regression

Regresses the residuals of each series after removing its own linear time trend, so a shared trend can no longer drive the result on its own. A relationship that stays significant here is better evidence of a genuine link between the two series.

Dep. Variable:	value_fred_CGMDLW2564_detrended	R-squared:	0.136
Model:	OLS	Adj. R-squared:	0.132
Method:	Least Squares	F-statistic:	37.94
Date:	Wed, 26 Aug 2026	Prob (F-statistic):	3.04e-09
Time:	12:24:10	Log-Likelihood:	-1604.9
No. Observations:	243	AIC:	3214.
Df Residuals:	241	BIC:	3221.
Df Model:	1		
Covariance Type:	nonrobust		

	coef	std err	t	P> t	[0.025	0.975]
const	-3.482e-11	11.508	-3.03e-12	1.000	-22.668	22.668
value_fred_SFTPINDM114SFRBSF_detrended	6.1602	1.000	6.159	0.000	4.190	8.130

Omnibus:	7.909	Durbin-Watson:	0.417
Prob(Omnibus):	0.019	Jarque-Bera (JB):	9.938
Skew:	0.259	Prob(JB):	0.00695
Kurtosis:	3.845	Cond. No.	11.5

Notes:

[1] Standard Errors assume that the covariance matrix of the errors is correctly specified.

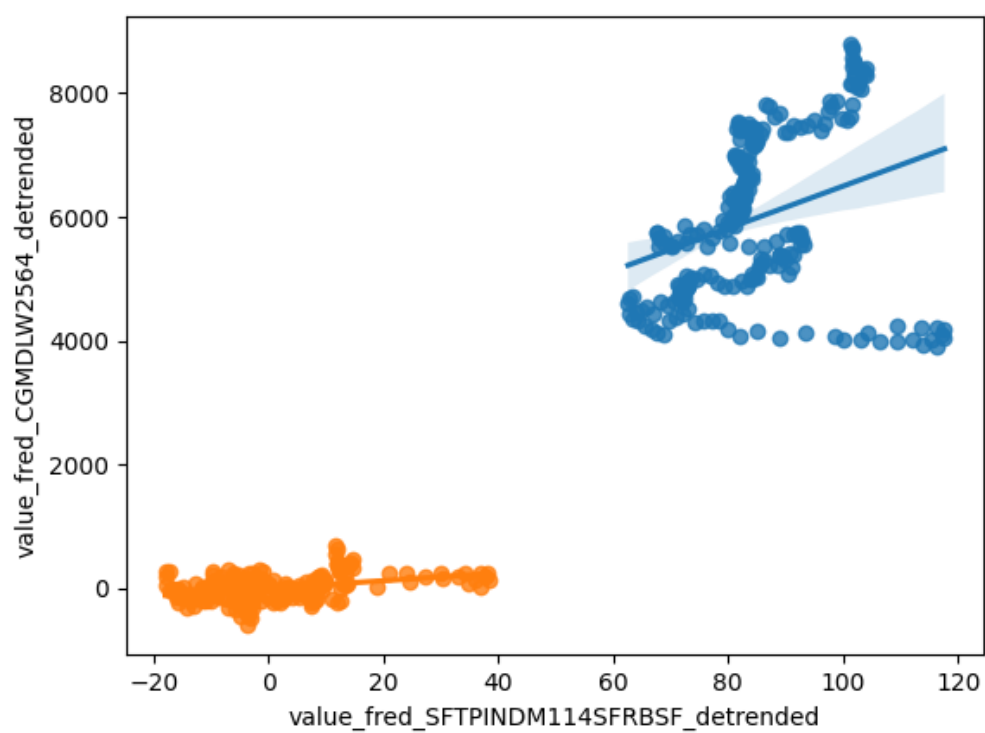


Figure 6: Detrended Regression Plot for 2026-08-26